

INTERVIEW PRACTICE DRAFT · JR2017937

Turning JRI's AI factory into a Japan FSI developer program

A focused proposal for the Senior Developer Relations Manager, Financial Services role

Daisuke Narita · 15 September 2026

Practice material only. NVIDIA's assignment asks candidates to complete the take-home without AI assistance. Do not submit this deck as-is.

01 · RECOMMENDATION

JRI is the right anchor for the next adoption step

Public signal

NVIDIA says the Japan Research Institute, the core IT company of SMBC Group, deployed an AI factory using Nemotron open models to turn financial data into intelligence.

JRI describes a mission-critical financial IT footprint and an advanced technology lab that evaluates and applies emerging AI.

Proposed focus

Use JRI as the anchor developer for a repeatable, governed financial-agent reference program that can extend beyond one group.

From one AI factory to a developer program that makes safe production repeatable.

Why this fits the role: Developer Relations is measured by developer behavior. The program must create working examples, technical confidence and partner-led adoption, not another broad product tour.

02 · OPPORTUNITY

The opportunity is the gap between a model demo and production

01

AI factory

Compute and models are available.

02

First use case

A team proves value in one workflow.

03

Developer kit

Reusable retrieval, agent and evaluation patterns.

04

Partner activation

JRI, NEC and cloud partners repeat the pattern.

05

Adoption

More teams reach a governed pilot.

Developer friction to remove

- Data cannot leave the approved environment.
- Quality, latency and cost are hard to compare.
- Prototype code does not become an auditable service.

Hypothesis to validate with JRI

A small, public-safe reference workflow plus hands-on support can reduce the distance from a financial AI experiment to a production candidate.

03 · TARGET DEVELOPERS

The target is the team that turns bank data into repeatable workflows

ANCHOR**JRI applied-AI and platform teams**

Need a secure reference architecture, evaluation discipline and a way to share patterns across SMBC businesses.

ADOPTER**Bank product and operations developers**

Need faster access to trusted internal knowledge, clear citations, predictable response time and audit trails.

MULTIPLIER**NEC, cloud and fintech engineers**

Need framework flexibility, supported APIs, sample code and partner enablement that shortens their own delivery cycle.

Shared technical needs

- Japanese document understanding and retrieval
- On-premises or hybrid deployment
- Quality, safety, cost and latency visibility

Adoption barriers

- Data governance and PII controls
- Procurement and skills shortage
- Fear of lock-in and unproven ROI

04 · USE CASE

A document-grounded agent is the fastest shared proof point

Help a relationship manager or operations team answer a Japanese financial question with evidence, a clear next action and an audit trail.

INPUT**Approved documents**

Policies, product notes, filings and procedures.

RETRIEVE**Parse and rank**

Find the right passages, tables and citations.

REASON**Guarded model**

Answer only within policy and evidence.

ACT**Agent tools**

Route to a workflow or human review.

LEARN**Measure**

Track quality, latency, cost and feedback.

Candidate connection: My MUIT experience showed me that an enterprise agent is adopted when response quality and user feedback are observable, not when a demo merely looks impressive.

Three NVIDIA building blocks connect prototype to production

NeMo Retriever

Grounded financial knowledge

Extract text, tables and charts from approved documents, then embed and rerank evidence for RAG.

NIM

Predictable inference

Package optimized model inference behind standard APIs across on-premises, cloud and hybrid environments.

NeMo Agent Toolkit

Agent integration and proof

Connect existing frameworks and tools, then instrument, evaluate and optimize the workflow.

Model layer: Nemotron is the open model family already associated with the JRI public signal. I would keep model choice swappable while standardizing the developer experience around retrieval, inference and evaluation.

The program needs one anchor and a partner ring

Anchor

JRI / SMBC Group

Own the reference use case, the approved data boundary and the first developer cohort.

NVIDIA Japan

Developer Relations + FSI solution team

Bring SDK education, architecture guidance, technical advocates and product feedback.

Implementation partner

NEC, whose 2026 partnership with JRI covers AI, cloud, security and the lifecycle from planning to operations.

Infrastructure ring

Approved cloud and on-prem partners provide deployment paths without forcing one environment.

Community ring

NVIDIA DLI, Japan developer events, universities and fintech builders turn one reference into many learning paths.

Developer Relations should create a tight 90-day loop

DAYS 0–30

Discover and baseline

- Interview JRI and adopter teams.
- Select one public-safe document workflow.
- Baseline quality, latency, cost and safety.

DAYS 31–60

Build and teach

- Publish a synthetic-data reference repo.
- Run two hands-on workshops and office hours.
- Capture developer feedback and blockers.

DAYS 61–90

Prove and multiply

- Run a joint demo day with JRI and NEC.
- Start one partner pilot.
- Launch a monthly developer clinic.

Dependency: A named JRI sponsor and an approved synthetic or public document set must exist before any workshop claims production readiness.

Adoption metrics should connect developers to pipeline

LAYER	MEASURE	PROPOSED 90-DAY TARGET	WHY IT MATTERS
Reach	Workshop attendance and qualified JRI / partner teams	40 attendees, 12 qualified teams	Developer interest reaches the right people.
Activation	Time to first grounded answer; weekly active developers	First success in 2 days; 20 active developers	The sample is usable outside a demo.
Technical proof	Groundedness, p95 latency, cost per request, safety incidents	Baseline established; no unresolved critical safety issue	Teams can make a production decision.
Business	Partner pilots and production candidates	3 pilots; 1 production candidate	Developer activity becomes GTM evidence.

Assumption: Targets are planning hypotheses, not public NVIDIA or JRI results. I would reset them after day-30 discovery.

The next six months are about repeatability and proof

Dependencies and risks

- JRI sponsor and approved data boundary
- Security, PII and model-governance review
- GPU capacity and deployment ownership
- Model quality and Japanese evaluation set
- Vendor lock-in and unclear ROI

My interview bridge

At MUIT, I worked on Agentforce in a bank CRM, Databricks-based agent observability, prompt tuning and context engineering.

My point: I would bring the same discipline to developer adoption: start with a real workflow, instrument quality, listen to users and make the next team faster.

The proposal is intentionally narrow: one anchor, one workflow, three NVIDIA building blocks, one 90-day proof loop.

Open question for the team: Which JRI financial workflow and developer audience would NVIDIA Japan want to prioritize first?

Key sources: NVIDIA Japan Blog · JRI–NEC release · NIM for Financial Services · NeMo Retriever · NeMo Agent Toolkit.